Lexicon Template

One project, three tiers, four fields, two checks

1 What this fills

How to Build a Lexicon settles the method and the two sources under it, and the schema it uses is yours, from the Tech Fluency page. Neither is repeated here. This file is the skeleton you copy when a project's turn comes, plus the markdown for the page that carries the result.

One lexicon per project. A term used by more than one project goes in the shared file for its cluster and the project entries point at it. A term whose sense differs between two projects stays in both, and each entry says how the other project uses it.

2 The file, and the macros it already has

Lexicon files live in `_side/_lexicons` and share `_house.tex` with the census file. Four macros are defined there and nothing else needs defining.

```
\term{Stackelberg equilibrium}          % a headword
\says{the quoted sentence}{locator}     % your own sentence, with where it lives
\reviewer{B7}{their phrase}{locator}    % a reviewer's word for the same thing
\begin{clash}{one-line title}...\end{clash}   % one term, two senses
```

The opening of the file, unchanged from the two that exist:

```
\ifx\LexiconMaster\undefined
  \documentclass[11pt]{article}
  \input{_house}
  \begin{document}
\fi

\lxHeader{[Project name]}{[what the terms are drawn from]}

\tableofcontents
\clearpage
```

3 Step one, the census

Every term the project's own files use, with the sentence that uses it and a locator. No definitions at this stage, and no selection. The census is what makes the entries writable in your words rather than in someone else's, and it is the file you open to check whether the reading was real.

```
\term{[the term as you write it]}
\says{[your sentence, verbatim]}{[file, section]}
\says{[a second sentence, where a second file uses it]}{[file, section]}
```

The stopping rule is coverage. A complete pass over the project's files adds no new term, and every term found is assigned to a tier or marked ambiguous. Not a word count, not a term count, and not the point at which the list looks long enough.

4 Step two, the tier

Your three tiers, and what each one buys. The tier is decided before the entry is written, because it decides how much of the entry gets written.

Tier	The test	Fields written
Active	Must define and use fluently, on the spot	All four
Working	Must recognize precisely; lookup is fine	Definition, Distinguishes it from
Peripheral	Know approximately where it belongs and retrieve when necessary	Definition, and a pointer to where it belongs

Only the Active tier reaches the website page. Working and Peripheral stay in the compiled file, which the page links to.

5 Step three, the entry

Four fields, in your order, on your Stackelberg example.

Stackelberg equilibrium
Definition: Leader commits; follower observes and best-responds.
Distinguishes it from: Nash: simultaneous strategic choice, no commitment advantage.
Operational test: Can one player commit before the other's decision?
In my project: Defender commits to a strategy; attacker responds.

5.1 Definition

One sentence. Taken from your manuscript where your manuscript defines it. Taken from the field's own source where it does not, with the source named. Written fresh only where neither has it, and said to be so.

Where the formal definition and your working understanding differ, both go in and each is labeled. The difference is the thing worth having, and a lexicon that records only the formal one hides it.

5.2 Distinguishes it from

The nearest neighbor, and the one property that separates the two. One neighbor per entry unless a second is genuinely as close.

This is the field that does the detecting. A person can hold a definition and still fail at the first unfamiliar case, and level one of your fluency scale will not catch it. Naming what the term is not is what catches it.

5.3 Operational test

A question with a yes or no answer that decides whether the term applies to a case in front of you. If the answer requires a paragraph, the test is not written yet.

Two failures to watch. A test that restates the definition tests nothing. A test that can only be answered by someone who already knows the answer is a definition wearing a question mark.

5.4 In my project

Where the term appears in this project's own work, with the locator. Concrete enough that the sentence can be found again: file and section, not file alone.

6 The clash, for a term whose two uses disagree

A term whose *In my project* field cites two files that use it differently does not get resolved into one entry. It gets a clash box, and the clash box is the most valuable thing in the file.

```
\begin{clash}{[one line, stating the disagreement]}
[Source one]: ‘‘[the sentence]’’, [locator].

[Source two]: ‘‘[the sentence]’’, [locator].

[One or two sentences saying what the disagreement is. Not which side
is right, unless you know.]
\end{clash}
```

The shortest one in the FOE-Dreamer census is three lines: a term appears in the deployment notes, is not one of the five defender actions, and appears nowhere else in the paper. That is a complete clash. It needs no resolution to be worth writing down.

7 Step four, the two checks

Both are cheap and both catch a wrong entry rather than a missing one.

Run the discrimination test in both directions. If the entry for one term names a second term as its neighbor, the second term's entry names the first. A one-way distinction usually means one of the two definitions is wrong.

Look for two locators that disagree. Any entry whose *In my project* field cites two files using the term differently becomes a clash box. These are the entries a reviewer trips on, and finding them is most of what the lexicon is for.

8 Placement, for a term that crosses communities

A term that cybersecurity, AI, and human factors all use is placed on the five dimensions from the dictionary page rather than defined three times. The row is the placement.

Dimension	**The range it runs over**
Object	actor, behavior, attack possibilities, environment
Epistemic operation	describe, infer, predict, simulate or enact
Specificity	generic adversary, adversary class, particular actor
Purpose	strategic response, risk analysis, defensive evaluation
Fidelity	abstract representation, executable reproduction

Two lines go under the table, because the table cannot carry them.

Salience. Which dimension decides the term. A concept is a set of regions plus weights on the dimensions, and a table of regions alone has dropped the weights.

Dimensions that move together. Where specificity rises with fidelity, or any other pair travels as one, say so in a line. Boxes on independent axes cannot express it, and nothing in the table rules out the combination that does not exist.

Then one check, run on the dimension rather than on the term. If two terms sit at two points on a dimension and a term at an intermediate point would be an instance of neither, that dimension is not carrying the distinction you think it is. Drop it or split it.

9 The website page

Each project's `lexicon.md` under `content/overview/3-year-agenda/` is currently front matter and a heading. Filled, it carries the Active tier and links to the compiled file, the way `resources/templates.md` does for the beamer theme.

```
---
description: [one sentence: what these terms are for]
icon: spell-check
---

# Lexicon

[One paragraph: which files the terms were taken from, and what the
tiers mean here.]
```

```
<table><thead><tr><th width="220">Term</th><th>Definition</th>
<th>Distinguishes it from</th></tr></thead><tbody>
[one row per Active term]
</tbody></table>

**Operational tests and project locations** are in the compiled file.
[**Download the lexicon (.pdf)**](...)

_Last updated: 2026-08_
```

Three columns on the page, four fields in the file. The operational test and the project location are the two that need a locator to be useful, and a locator is worth nothing to a reader who does not have the repository.

10 Filling it

The order is the four steps, and only step three writes. Census, tier, entries, checks. A project whose census is not finished does not get entries started, because an entry written from memory is an entry written in the field's words rather than yours, and the whole apparatus exists to prevent that.

11 Sources

- The three fluency levels, the Active, Working and Peripheral tiers, the four fields and the Stackelberg example are yours, from the Tech Fluency page, `content/overview-2/tech-fluency-from-concept-image-to-concept-defintions.md`. The example is reproduced with its internal dash written as a colon.
- The five dimensions and the ranges they run over are yours, from the Cyber-Human-AI Dictionary front page.
- The justification for the four fields, the salience and correlation lines, and the convexity check are in `_side/_lexicons/lexicon_method.tex`, which cites Tall and Vinner 1981 and Gärdenfors for them.
- The macros, the census shape and the clash shape are from `_side/_lexicons/_house.tex` and `_side/_lexicons/your_terms_foedreamer.tex`.